17.4.3 Prerequisites

- Laravel 12 project set up locally
- SQLite installed and available (usually pre-installed in most environments)
- PHP 8.1+ and Composer installed
- Basic knowledge of Laravel routing and artisan commands

> *This lab uses **PHP 8.4**, **Laravel 12** and **Visual Studio Code** as the primary editor.*

17.4.4 Steps

Here's a step-by-step guide to setting up Laravel Telescope in a Laravel 12 application using SQLite.

17.4.4.1 Step 1: Prepare Laravel Project

If you haven't created a Laravel 12 project, run:

```
laravel new telescope-demo
cd telescope-demo
code .
```

Accept all the default options during installation. This will create a new Laravel project named `telescope-demo` and use SQLite as the default database. The last command will open the project in Visual Studio Code.

You should see the project in Visual Studio Code.

17.4.4.2 Step 2: Configure `.env` to Use SQLite

Since we use default SQLite database, we don't do anything. We can verify this by checking the `.env` file. Open the `.env` file and check the following lines:

```
DB_CONNECTION=sqlite
```

17.4.4.3 Step 3: Install Laravel Telescope

Use Composer to install Telescope (dev only):

```
composer require laravel/telescope --dev
```